

01 SMALL TALK

What app do you open first thing in the morning?

When you make a small mistake, do you laugh it off or get a little embarrassed?

Do you usually text or call when you contact your close friends?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

① ~~"AI is very convenient for work."~~

✓ "AI is really handy for work. / AI makes work a lot easier."

문법은 맞지만 convenient는 한국인이 너무 자주 써요. 사람·작업엔 handy나 makes ~ easier가 더 자연스러워요.

② ~~"I used AI to make my report."~~

✓ "I used AI to write my report. / I used AI to put my report together."

보고서·글은 make가 아니라 write를 써요. 자료를 짜 맞추는 느낌이면 put together도 좋아요.

③ ~~"AI is developing very fast."~~

✓ "AI is advancing really fast. / AI is moving so fast these days."

develop도 틀린 건 아니지만, 기술 발전엔 advancing이 더 자연스럽고 일상 대화에선 moving fast를 써요.

03 오늘의 워업

리더 또는 서포터가 본인 관련 3개 문장 (2개 진실, 1개 거짓) 읽음. 멤버가 거짓 맞히기. 그다음 다음 사람.

WARM-UP

Two Truths, One Lie (8분)

1 I have used an AI app to practice English speaking.

2 I feel less nervous talking to an app than to a real person.

3 I once talked to an AI app for more than 30 minutes in one day.

AI · MAIN DISCUSSION

AI English Apps — Low-Pressure Practice or Real-Life Speaking?

BACKGROUND

AI 영어 앱은 사람 앞에서 말하는 부담을 줄여준다는 점에서 매력적이예요. 틀려도 다시 말할 수 있고, 발음이나 문장을 바로 고쳐볼 수 있으니까요. 하지만 앱 안에서 잘 말하는 것과 실제 사람 앞에서 말하는 것은 다른 경험이에요. 표정, 반응 속도, 농담, 끼어들기 같은 요소는 사람과 대화할 때만 느낄 수 있죠. AI는 좋은 연습 상대지만, 실제 대화로 넘어가는 타이밍이 필요해요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

AI English apps are helpful because they lower the fear of speaking. A learner can repeat, pause, try again, and get feedback without feeling embarrassed. That makes practice easier to start and easier to keep up. But speaking well inside an app is not the same as speaking with a person. Real conversations include facial reactions, speed, interruptions, jokes, and the pressure of being understood right away. AI can build confidence, vocabulary, and rhythm, but it should probably be a bridge, not a destination. The key question is when low-pressure practice should turn into real-life speaking. AI at work can feel like an advantage too, because it helps people draft, summarize, and learn faster. But it can also create pressure when coworkers seem to use it better, or when the company expects everyone to adapt quickly. The real line is whether AI lowers stress or quietly raises the standard for everyone.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

low-pressure — 부담 없는

freeze up — (긴장해서) 얼어붙다

laugh it off — 웃어넘기다

lean on (something) — ~에 의존하다

a crutch — 기대게 되는 것, 목발

a stepping stone — 디딤돌

TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, talking to an AI app feels ___ for me, but ___.

Compared to a real person, an AI app ___, so I ___.

It really comes down to ___, which an app can't teach well.

The part an app can't really copy is ___, because ___.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'practice-with-an-app-first' or a 'just-jump-into-real-conversation' English learner?
- 2 When was the last time you used an app to practice English out loud? Which app, and how did it feel?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick just one to improve your English: an AI speaking app, a human tutor, or a language exchange?
- 4 On a scale of 1 to 5, how often do you speak English out loud to an app or AI instead of a person?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Does speaking English with an AI app feel safer than speaking with a real person? Why?

↳ Honestly, talking to an AI app feels ___ for me, but ___.

↳ Compared to a real person, an AI app ___, so I ___.

Q2. What part of a real conversation is hardest for an app to teach — jokes, speed, interruptions, or the pressure to answer right away?

↳ It really comes down to ___, which an app can't teach well.

↳ The part an app can't really copy is ___, because ___.

Q3. When should you stop practicing only with an app and start talking to real people? What is your signal?

↳ I'd say the right moment is when ___, because ___.

↳ Looking back, my signal was ___ — that's when I ___.

Q4. Can someone get too comfortable using only AI? Have you ever leaned on a tool too much?

↳ When I think about it, yes, you can ___ because ___.

↳ In my case, I leaned on ___ too much, and ___.

Q5. At work or study, does AI lower your stress, or does it quietly raise the standard for everyone?

↳ It depends on ___, but usually AI ___ for me.

↳ The way I see it, AI ___ at first, but over time ___.